

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a newspaper in Hong Kong:

Young Hongkongers head north to Shenzhen for job opportunities

Can't find your dream job in Hong Kong? Shenzhen's Qianhai economic zone may be the solution but you'd better be prepared to live without Facebook or Twitter.

Herman Leung Ka-hin, who is from Hong Kong, is now working for a finance company in Shenzhen. Leung graduated this year and made the decision to work on the Mainland during his final year of study.

"I believe in the prospect of mainland China economic growth," he said. "It would be better for me to start my career in the Mainland."

Unlike jobs in Hong Kong with well-established career paths, Leung said his boss told him to expect uncertainty in his job because there were new policies and new developments all the time.

Leung said that would give him more opportunities to try something new.

"Before I came here, I worried about working with mainland colleagues as there might be cultural differences," he said. "But after working here, I found that I had been over-worrying and I work with my mainland colleagues well."

Leung said pay levels in Qianhai were similar to Hong Kong but the cost of living was much lower.

One thing he would like to see improve is the traffic. He lives in an apartment in northern Shenzhen provided by his employer and has to spend more than an hour travelling to or from Qianhai due to traffic jams.

Hongkongers working in Qianhai also miss out on some popular social media networks such as Facebook and Twitter, which are banned on the Mainland along with some overseas websites.

Your group has been asked to discuss whether Hongkongers could benefit from working in Shenzhen. You may want to talk about:

- advantages and disadvantages of working in Shenzhen
- whether this will become a popular trend
- advice for people who would like to work in Shenzhen
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Have you ever been to Shenzhen?
2. Would you like to work in Shenzhen?
3. Would you like to live outside Hong Kong?
4. What would you miss if you left Hong Kong?
5. What would be the best thing about working in Shenzhen?
6. What would you find difficult about working in mainland China?
7. Is it more common for Hongkongers to work outside Hong Kong than in the past?
8. Does Hong Kong lose or benefit from young people working in Shenzhen?